primarily to Israel's benefit, but partly concluded with the Camp David Accords of 1978. [3]

The awakening of modern Islamism had its origins in the mid-twentieth century. The Indian-born Pakistani Abul Ala Maududi, founder of Jamaat-e-Islami, was among the first to articulate a vision for a modern political order based on Islamism, one that was distinct from both ethnic or linguistic nationalism and apolitical Islam. [4] In Egypt, Maududi's contemporary Sayyid Qutb—whose ideas led to the foundation of the Muslim Brotherhood—argued that the rejection of nationalism, socialism, secularism, and liberalism and the embrace of Islamism were the solutions to the moral and political decay of the Islamic world. [5] The Shi'a cleric Ayatollah Ruhollah Khomeini argued in a similar vein that '[W]e have set as our goal the world-wide spread of the influence of Islam . . . We wish . . . to destroy the systems which are based on [Zionism, capitalism, and Communism] and to promote the Islamic order of the Prophet.' [6] Khomeini also advanced the notion of the ummah by playing down differences between Shi'as and Sunnis.

The year 1979 proved a turning point for Islamism, a moment when many of its political objectives began to be realized and militarized. In Iran, Khomeini inspired a successful revolution against the corruption and authoritarianism of the Shah of Iran, resulting in the establishment of a revolutionary state. [7] Just as significantly, in Saudi Arabia, an uprising led by Mohammed Abdullah al-Qahtani—a self-proclaimed *mehdi* (or redeemer)—resulted in a takeover of Islam's holiest site at Mecca. While violently suppressed, the episode generated fears of a radical Islamist revolution in Saudi Arabia. It encouraged Saudi rulers to express a greater tolerance for extremist interpretations of Islamism within the country, and promote those ideas and beliefs abroad, including through generous financial support. [8] By the end of 1979, Islamist mujahideen had begun to organize to expel Soviet forces from Afghanistan, where they were supporting an embattled communist regime. These efforts were planned and supported by Pakistan, Saudi Arabia and the United States. [9] Thus it was in 1979 that Islamism moved from the ideological to the political and military